

General observation of CV and cover letter

1. Header / Personal Information

Full Name

Address

Email Address

Phone Number

2. Professional Summary / Profile

A brief 3–5-line paragraph highlighting your key skills, experience, and value you bring to the employer. Tailor it to the type of roles you are applying for.

Example:

Reliable and detail-oriented professional with 3 years of experience in office administration and community engagement. Skilled in data management, customer service, and coordination. Seeking

to leverage my experience to contribute effectively as a Field Officer at VisionFund Malawi.

3. Key Skills / Competencies

Use bullet points to showcase your relevant technical and soft skills. Make this job-specific.

Examples:

- Office administration and record keeping
- Client engagement and customer service
- Data collection and reporting (ODK, Excel)
- Community mobilization and training
- Communication and interpersonal skills
- Time management and problem-solving

4. Education

List your most recent first. Include institution, qualification, year, and relevant achievements if any.

5. Work Experience

Use reverse chronological order (most recent first). Include: Job Title, Organization, Location, Dates, and 3–5 bullet points of key responsibilities and achievements. Focus on results and contributions, not just tasks.

Example:

Position: Office Assistant

Organization: VisionFund Malawi

Location: Mwanza

Duration: 2023 – Present

key responsibilities

- Supported daily office operations and document management
- Assisted with client data entry and reporting using ODK
- Coordinated community activities and Savings Group meetings

6. Certifications & Training (Optional)

Include anything relevant to the job

Example:

- ODK Data Collection Training (if any)

7. References

Include 3 credible referees with contact details.

Referee Name

Position

Organization

Phone Number

Email Address

Take note

Explain Significant Employment Gaps

Redundant Educational Information

- The CV includes a Junior Certificate of Education (2007).
- Including the JCE is unnecessary and consumes valuable space once a higher qualification like the Malawi School Certificate of Education (MSCE) has been obtained.

Vague and Repetitive Job Duties

Serious Grammar & English Errors

- “I am very familiar working windows server...” (incorrect grammar).
- “I am excellent in cleaning analysis of complex data at using excel.”
- “any other prescribe requirements” (should be prescribed).